ALL ABOUT NAMES

A boy named Vir, meaning 'brave' in Hindi, may turn out to be a truly brave person but another boy named Vijay, meaning 'victory' in Hindi, may always be on the losing side. Some people have suitable names, while others do not. This is true of birds, insects, and animals too!

A. Name these birds that have 'right' names!

1. I make my nest by weaving grass stems and other plant fibres, using my beak as a needle.
   W __ __ __ __ __ B I R D

2. I am a bird that can sing. Hence, my name.
   S __ __ __ B I R D

3. I am a long-tailed songbird, found mainly in tropical America. I can mimic the calls and songs of other birds.
   M __ __ __ __ __ __ B I R D

B. Name these animals that have 'wrong' names!

1. I am a tailless, South American rodent, typically kept as a pet. Though the first part of my name is a country in West Africa, I have nothing to do with that country.
   G __ __ __ __ __ __ __ __

2. I am also known as a glow-worm, though I am not a worm. I am actually a winged beetle.
   F __ __ __ __ __ __

3. I am a lizard but I have been named after a creature that lived long ago in the past.
   K __ __ O __ __ D __ __ G O __.

Find Out

. . . the names of two more creatures that have the 'right' names, and two creatures that do not.

THE AMAZING WORLD OF ANIMALS

Write T for 'true' and F for 'false'.

1. A dog's ears are far more sensitive than a human being's. .....
2. Orangutans and dolphins are among the least intelligent creatures in the world. .....
3. A seahorse has a suit of armour to protect it from its enemies. .....
4. A jellyfish cannot regrow its tentacles. .....
5. Blue whales have the largest eyes among animals, each measuring 16 inches across. .....
6. A flying fox is actually a fox. .....
7. The great Indian bustard, found in India and Pakistan, is an endangered species. This bird feeds on small snakes, lizards, scorpions, wheat, millet and groundnuts. .....
8. At 188 decibels, the trumpet of an elephant is the loudest sound produced by an animal. .....
9. The cheetah is the the fastest land animal. .....
10. Hermit crabs wear empty mollusc shells for protection. When they outgrow these shells, they grow shells of their own. .....
11. Snakes can hear very well. .....

The great Indian bustard

Jellyfish

Hermit crab

Did You Know ?

- The heart of a blue whale is the size of a small car.
- Oysters can change from one gender to the other and back again.
- Mosquitoes don't have jaws, so they cannot bite. They stab!

Oyster